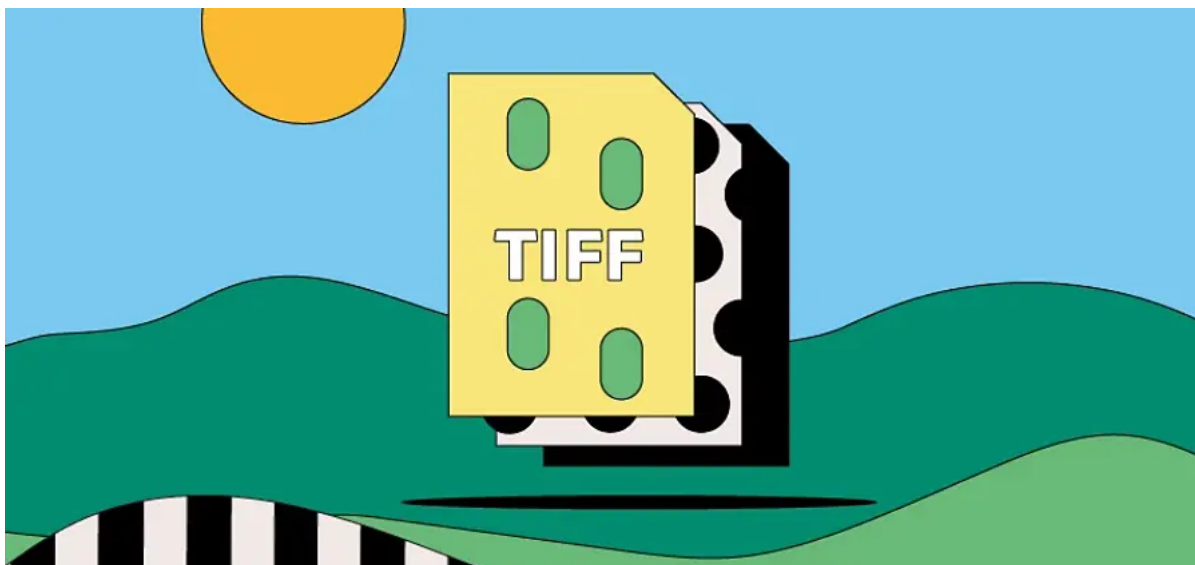




PHOTOGRAPHY

TIFF files.

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TIFFs are a file format popular with graphic designers and photographers for their flexibility, high quality, and near-universal compatibility. Learn more about these raster graphic files and how you can put them to use in your next project.

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JUMP TO SECTION

[History of the TIFF file](#)

[What are TIFFs used for](#)

[Pros and cons of TIFF files](#)

[How to open a TIFF file](#)

[How to create and edit a TIFF file](#)

[TIFF files: frequently asked questions](#)

What is a TIFF file?

A TIFF, which stands for Tag Image File Format, is a computer file used to store raster graphics and image information. A favourite among photographers, TIFFs are a handy way to store high-quality images before editing if you want to avoid lossy file formats.

TIFF files:

- Have either a .tiff or .tif extension.
- Are a lossless form of file compression, which means they're larger than most but don't lose image quality.
- Work with Windows, Linux, and macOS.

TIFFs aren't the smallest files around, but they enable a user to tag up extra image information and data, such as additional layers. They're also compatible with editing software like [Adobe](#)

[Photoshop](#).

History of the TIFF file.

Aldus Corporation created the TIFF file in the mid-1980s for use in desktop publishing. TIFFs retained high-quality data and could publish content directly from a computer. The file was designed as a universally applicable format for desktop scanners — hardware that previously handled, depending on the make and model, only a limited set of file formats.

Initially, TIFFs were restricted to print publications before they expanded into digital content. Aldus Corporation was later acquired by Adobe, which has since been responsible for the copyright of the file format.

What are TIFFs used for?

TIFFs are popular across a range of industries — such as design, photography, and desktop publishing. TIFF files can be used for:

- **High-quality photographs.**

TIFFs are perfect for retaining lots of impressively detailed image data because they use a predominately lossless form of file compression. This makes them a great choice for professional photographers and editors.

- **High-resolution scans.**

The detailed image quality stored within a TIFF means they're ideal for scanned images and high-resolution documents. You might find them a useful choice for storing high-resolution images of your artwork or personal documents.

- **Container files.**

TIFFs also work as container files that store smaller JPEGs that are called subfiles. You could store several lower-resolution [JPEGs](#) within one TIFF if you wanted to email a selection of photos to a contact.

- Tiff files can hold layers created with an image editing program like Photoshop and can be read by other similar programs, making it a non proprietary layer-based file format This makes them useful for preserving complex image edits. (Full compatibility may vary)
- The Tiff file format can hold some vector elements such as clipping paths, image frames, and simple paths, which

means it can be read by vector programs such as Adobe Illustrator (while the Tiff file format remains a raster format, the vector information is adequately read and converted by the vector editing program, again full compatibility depends on the software)

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Pros and cons of TIFF files.

As with any file format, the usefulness of TIFFs depends on how they're implemented. The following are some of a TIFF's advantages and disadvantages.

Advantages of TIFF files.

- Predominantly lossless compression means TIFF files retain the original image's detail and color depth — perfect for high-quality professional photos.
- Their impressive detail means TIFFs are ideal for high-resolution scans, such as backing up your handmade artwork and personal documents.
- TIFFs are universal and adaptable as a file format, so can be used with the major operating systems.
- The file can work as a container for smaller-sized JPEGs, storing multiple images in one master raster graphic.
- TIFFs are a good option to store high-resolution images ahead of editing and asset creation.
- The Tiff file format can accommodate from 1 bit (black and white to 32 bits, with an Alpha channel
Making it either 8 bits per channel + an 8 bit transparency Alpha channel for RGBA 32 bits, or 16 bits per channel for RGB. Perfect for HDR photos.
- The size limit for a tiff file is 4GB which makes it an excellent alternative from proprietary file format to hold a bigger amounts of data
- The Tiff file format can accept different colour models such as CMYK, RGB, CIE lab etc.
- It also retain spot colours used in the printing industry for printing special inks or finishes.
- **Other accepted colour models are:**

• Other accepted colour models are.

Grayscale: For images that only contain shades of gray.

Indexed Color: Uses a color palette to represent images with a limited number of colors.

YCbCr: Commonly used in video and digital photography, representing color as brightness (Y) and two color difference components (Cb and Cr).

- It can accept transparency the same way as a PNG-24 does.

Disadvantages of TIFF files.

- Detail and resolution lead to TIFFs being quite large files. They can take up valuable space on your drive.
- Their size makes them difficult to share or send to contacts or clients.
- Their high quality makes them a poor choice for website design, since detailed images can slow a website's loading speed. Lighter file formats, like a [JPEG](#), might be more useful for online images.
- Certain features can be read differently by different software, notably adjacent ones like text, vector paths, and non essential tags.

How to open a TIFF file.

As a tagged image file, most computers can open and handle TIFFs, but you'll need editing software like [Adobe Photoshop](#) to make any edits to the original image. If you're just looking to view the TIFF, follow these steps:

For macOS:

1. Select the TIFF file you want to open on your drive, or wherever you have it stored.
2. Double-click.
3. The TIFF image should open automatically in Apple Preview.

For Windows:

1. Highlight the file you want to open.
2. Double-click.
3. The TIFF file should open in Windows Photo Viewer.

You can set the files to open in a different program, such as Apple Photos, by changing the default software in your device's settings.

How to create and edit a TIFF file.

Because they're among the most common file formats around, TIFFs are relatively easy to create. Simply follow the three steps below:

- Go to File > Save As.
- Choose File Format from the dropdown menu.
- Choose TIFF.

You can reduce the file of a Tiff file by applying a compression, either lossless (bigger file, no damage to the image), such as

LZW, or using JPEG which is generally smaller in size but compresses the image by simplifying its content, which damages the integrity of the image.

You can maintain a multi-layered file while compressing as JPEG, as it only affects the pixel content of each layer.

You may need to import your images into Microsoft Paint for Windows devices to save as a TIFF. Alternatively, programs like Adobe Photoshop have a built-in capacity to save files as .tiff.

Tiff files can contain tags that retain some extra information that some software can read: such as authoring, copyrights and other useful information. In addition, you can tag your Tiff files with the content authenticity initiative to check the provenance of a file, and see (among other things) in which way it has been altered and if the image is safe to use.

<https://contentauthenticity.org/>

A TIFF is an image file — so it stores photographic and graphical data. You won't be able to edit the original file information without editing software, like [Adobe Photoshop](#) or [Illustrator](#).

TIFF files: frequently asked questions

Is PNG better than TIFF?

Does Word support TIFF images?

Can you edit a TIFF file in Word?

How do I print all pages from a TIFF file?

Are TIFFs smaller than PDFs?

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